

AARON K. CLARK

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SUMMARY

Principal Software Engineer with 25+ years across software engineering, cybersecurity, and cloud infrastructure. Currently architecting systems and building ML pipelines for an AI startup. Prior work spans defense, manufacturing, cloud operations, and information security. CISSP in progress.

EXPERIENCE

Ronin 48 Mar 2026 - Present
Principal Software Architect & ML Engineer (Contract) Remote

- Designing overall system architecture for an AI startup; defining technical standards, guiding technology selection, and ensuring scalable, production-ready software design across the platform.
- Implementing and operationalizing machine learning pipelines; guiding model selection and deployment strategy, and integrating ML capabilities into production systems.

Career Break Nov 2024 - Mar 2026
EMT-B Certification & Community Service Minden, Nebraska

- Completed Emergency Medical Technician (EMT-B) certification and joined Minden Volunteer Fire Department as probationary firefighter / EMT. Self-directed study in AI/ML systems.

Black Hills Information Security / Active Countermeasures Mar 2024 - Nov 2024
Senior Developer Remote

- Upgraded Windows Service from dotNET Framework 4.x to dotNet 8, refactored code to be testable and created unit tests. Built Windows ports of Unix software. Wrote documentation and tutorials for blog posts and webcasts.

CrowdStrike Aug 2022 - Mar 2024
Senior Technical Support Engineer Remote

- SME for SaaS and on-prem LogScale(Humio), Kafka, and log shippers. Created sandbox infrastructure using terraform and k8s. Wrote automation and tooling in bash and Python.

CloudHesive Dec 2021 - May 2022
Cloud Operations Supervisor Remote

- Led the Cloud Operations team supporting 2000+ customer systems across AWS, Azure, and VMware; hired and developed engineers focused on security and operational excellence.

CloudHesive Aug 2021 - Dec 2021
Cloud Support Engineer II Remote

- Supported more than 2000 customer systems on AWS, Azure, and VMWare Infrastructures. Used Datadog, SumoLogic, and NewRelic to monitor customer systems and networks. Managed backup and recovery processes. Technologies included CloudFormation, CloudWatch, EC2, EFS, ELB, IAM, RDS, S3, VPC, and Workspaces.

Tmutla Feb 2021 - Aug 2021
Cybersecurity Consultant Grand Island, Nebraska

- Performed Web Application Penetration tests and wrote customer reports.

Reinke Manufacturing Company

Dec 2015 - Feb 2021

*Senior Developer**Remote*

- Led application development of middleware connecting an AS/400-based ERP system and a WinForms sales application. Built the authentication/authorization system using ASP.NET MVC 4. Stood up and maintained Azure infrastructure. Evaluated 3rd-party SAST tools and made recommendations for their implementation.

Alpine Testing Solutions, Inc.

2014 - 2015

*Software Developer**Remote*

- Monitored and mitigated data import errors; created T-SQL queries for data imports and exports; wrote XML for manual data imports.

Orthman Manufacturing, Inc.

2012 - 2014

*IT Specialist II**Lexington, Nebraska*

- Led virtualization project to migrate physical Windows Machines to virtual hosts. Created .NET Applications for internal use.

Intellicom Computer Consulting, Inc.

2009 - 2012

*Senior Engineering Technician**Kearney, Nebraska*

- Installed and maintained Active Directory, File, and Exchange servers.

Earlier Experience

1998 - 2008

- **United States Marine Corps** – Information Specialist (2003–2008), Washington, DC. Operated and supported the USMC network; graduate of the USMC Information Assurance Manager Course.
- **Rackspace** – Linux Systems Administrator (2003), San Antonio, TX.
- **Cimarron Software Services** – Systems Analyst at NASA Johnson Space Center (2001–2002), Houston, TX.
- **MegaHaus** – Help Desk Technician (1998), Dickinson, TX.

TECHNICAL STRENGTHS

AI/ML	LangChain, LangGraph, Hugging Face, OpenAI API, Anthropic API, Ollama, RAG pipelines, vector databases (pgvector, Pinecone), prompt engineering
Cloud	AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, IAM, VPC, ELB, EFS, CloudFormation, CloudWatch), Azure, Terraform
Tools	Burp Suite, Postman, Wireshark, NMap, LogScale (Humio), Kafka, Docker, Kubernetes
Languages	Python, C#, TypeScript, JavaScript, VB.NET, T-SQL, PowerShell, Bash
Certifications	CISSP (In Progress), SSCP, AWS Solutions Architect Associate, AWS Cloud Practitioner, CompTIA A+, CompTIA Network+, MS: Programming in C#
Memberships	OWASP, ACM, DC402, RITSEC, SPARSA.ORG, OperationCode

EDUCATION

Eastern University

2026 – Present

MS, Data Analytics (In Progress)

University of Maryland University College

Bachelor of Science, Computer and Information Science

Rochester Institute of Technology

MicroMaster's in Cybersecurity

Kennesaw State University

Graduate Certificate, Computer Science

Colorado State University

Graduate Certificate, IT Project Management

University of Maryland University College

Undergraduate Certificate, Unix System Administration

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Minden Volunteer Fire Department

Probationary Member / EMT-B

Dec 2024 - Present

Minden, Nebraska

- Serve as probationary firefighter and Emergency Medical Technician.

Women in CyberSecurity (WiCyS)

Student Mentor

Mar 2021 - Mar 2024

Remote

- Mentored students pursuing careers in cybersecurity.

Harvard University

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2022

Remote

- Teaching assistant for the Online Computing Mini Course.

Army National Guard

OPFOR Lead

Jul 2021

Remote

- Red Team (OPFOR) Team Leader for Cybershield 2021.